



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Agriculture
BUREAU OF FISHERIES AND AQUATIC RESOURCES
REGIONAL FISHERIES LABORATORY XII
J. Catolico St., Lagao, General Santos City

Document Type Standard Operating Procedures	Revision No: 0	Date Adopted: 13 Aug 2019	Page No: Page 1 of 5
Document Code: SOP-02	FACILITIES AND ENVIRONMENTAL CONDITIONS		

Introduction

This procedure describes the infrastructure and laboratories' environmental conditions which are implemented to facilitate correct performance of Tests.

1. Responsibilities

1. Laboratory Manager
2. Quality Assurance Manager
3. Technical Manager
4. Laboratory Analyst

2. Location

2.1. The laboratories occupy two floors in BFAR RFL XII building as described in the following (LR 02-01, Layout of BFAR Laboratory):

- Microbiology Laboratory is found on the 1st level while Chemistry and Fish Health Laboratories are found on the 2nd level of BFAR Regional Fisheries Laboratory Building.

3. Specifications

3.1. Every measurement is affected to a lesser or bigger degree by the environmental conditions under which it is carried out. For this reason, the laboratories take all necessary precautions to ensure that existing environmental conditions do not invalidate the results or adversely affect the required quality of the tests. The monitoring, control and recording of environmental conditions (LF 02-01, Environmental Conditions Monitoring) is accomplished through the use of proper measuring equipment.

3.2. The laboratories' premises are safe, clean and well lit. Additionally they are constructed according to specifications required to ensure performance of measurements according to the declared measurement uncertainty and are detailed among the various laboratories, as given below:

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Laboratory	Temperature	Relative Humidity	Other
BFAR RFL Chemistry Unit	23 ± 3 °C	50 ± 15 %	---
BFAR RFL Microbiology Unit	21-23°C	45-50%	—
BFAR RFL Molecular Diagnosis Unit	23 ± 3 °C	50 ± 15 %	---

Any modification, renovation and rehabilitation are reported to and acted upon by Regional Director.

Pest control program is scheduled annually.

First aid kit, eye wash, emergency shower and spill kit are available and accessible to all personnel.

3.3. Control of environmental conditions is carried out through the use of an individual air conditioning system per laboratory capable of achieving required specifications as detailed above.

3.4. Monitoring and recording of temperature and relative humidity is achieved through the use of portable calibrated measuring equipment. -RFL XII, in particular, uses equipment to data log in real time those conditions. Recordings of above conditions constitute valuable records for the conditions under which analysis and tests are carried out, and safely retained for a time period at least equal to the time for which pertinent report of tests are preserved.

3.5. The technical staff of each laboratory attends environmental temperature and relative humidity measurements to ensure that they remain within specifications. Tests are immediately halted when environmental conditions jeopardize the results of the tests that are carried out. Such events are treated as possible non-conformity, as described in SOP-10.

3.6. In case of power interruptions during analysis, the analyst must stop the analysis until electrical power returns or generator is switched on. The analyst must check the environmental conditions and if it is in the desired level, analysis can continue.

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4. Security and Access

4.1. Access to the Analytical Laboratories premises is generally restricted. Laboratory personnel must wear their personal protective equipment (laboratory gowns, gloves, masks) for the prevention of contamination, interference or adverse influences on laboratory activities. Refer to SOP 02-02, General Procedures for Housekeeping.

4.2. On the entire duration of the analysis, working inside the testing area must not work alone for precautionary and safety purposes.

4.3. Visitors are allowed to move around only when accompanied by laboratory personnel. They are provided with color coded IDs by the security guard indicating the designated area and must adhere to the safety protocols of the laboratory. Visitors are required to read, understand and sign the Declaration Form for Visitors (LF 01-01).

4.3.1. The color coding of IDs are as follows:

BFAR XII-RFL whole laboratory and facility – Blue

Receiving area – Purple

Microbiology Unit – Green

Chemistry Unit – Yellow

Fish Health Unit – Red

4.3.2. For witnessing of customer-specific laboratory activities, customer must provide a letter of request addressed to the laboratory manager and wait for approval. Customers are contacted through phone call or e-mail regarding approval of request. Customers are also informed to provide their own personal protective equipment such as laboratory gowns.

4.3.3. Customers requesting witness of laboratory activities are guided by the Technical Manager to the specific unit of analysis requested. Restrictions are imposed so that customers cannot visit other units not included in their request.

Specific areas for witnessing are as follows:

A. Chemistry analysis – Working Area only

B. Microbiology analysis – Working Area only

C. Fish Health analysis – Parasitology/Gross Examination Area

D. PCR analysis - Hallway

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4.4. After the end of work, all entrances are locked and keys are placed in the safekeeping of the BFAR RFL XII Office.

5. Housekeeping

5.1 All laboratory units are cleaned regularly. It is the responsibility of all personnel to ensure good housekeeping to the laboratory premises where they do every day work. The supervisor of each laboratory unit is responsible for good housekeeping within his area of responsibility. Refer to SOP 02-02, General Procedures for Housekeeping.

6. Documents and Forms

SOP 02-01, Layout of BFAR Laboratories

SOP 02-02, General Procedures for Housekeeping

SOP-10, Control and Handling Non conformities

LF 01-01, Declaration Form (Visitors)

LF 02-01, Environmental Conditions Monitoring

7. References

LASR01 Supplementary Requirements of Accreditation of Chemical Testing Laboratories

LASR02 Supplementary Requirements of Accreditation of Biological Testing Laboratories

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8. Document History

Revision No.	Issue Date	Original Entry	Revised as	Recall Date

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